

Submittal Tracker Pro: Go-To-Market & Launch Strategy

This document outlines the strategic blueprint for launching Submittal Tracker Pro, focusing on beta testing, pricing, marketing, and post-development essentials.

1. The Beta Test: How Many & How Long?

How many people?

Aim for 5 to 10 highly engaged testers.

Do not launch to 100 people. You want a small, intimate group of your *ideal customers* (e.g., Project Engineers, Project Managers, Estimators). It's much better to have 5 users who use it every single day and give you harsh, actionable feedback than 50 people who log in once and never return.

How long?

4 to 6 weeks.

- **Weeks 1-2:** Expect to uncover critical bugs, workflow friction, and things you didn't anticipate. You will be shipping rapid fixes.
- **Weeks 3-4:** Focus shifts to UI polishing, feature tweaks, and ensuring the app doesn't just work, but feels intuitive.
- **Weeks 5-6:** Transition them to paid users or use them to gather powerful case studies and testimonials ("*This saved me 6 hours on the Johnson High School project.*").

Pro-Tip: Make it a closed, exclusive Beta. "I'm looking for 5 Project Managers to test an AI tool that automates submittal logs. It's free for 2 months in exchange for your feedback."

2. Pricing Strategy: How Much to Charge?

Construction software commands a premium because it saves highly paid professionals hours of tedious, mind-numbing work. Base your price on the **value of time saved**.

If a Project Engineer makes \$40-\$50/hr and your tool saves them 5 hours per submittal package, you are saving them \$200-\$250 per project in pure labor costs (not to mention avoiding costly errors).

Recommended SaaS Subscription Tiers:

- **Starter / Solo PM (\$49 - \$79 / month):** Limited to a few active projects or a cap on AI spec extractions per month. Good for freelancers or small shops.
- **Pro / Mid-Sized Team (\$149 - \$199 / month):** This is your sweet spot. Unlimited projects, full AI sourcing, export to Excel, priority support.
- **Enterprise (\$499+ / month):** Unlimited seats, custom integrations (e.g., Procore export), dedicated account manager.

Alternative approach: Per-Project Pricing (\$50 - \$100 per project). Some contractors prefer this because they can easily bill the cost directly to a specific job number rather than absorbing it as overhead. However, monthly recurring revenue (MRR) is generally better for your business.

3. Go-To-Market: How to Market It

Forget expensive ads for now. Your best marketing tool is the **"Aha!" moment**.

- **The 60-Second Demo Video:** Record a Loom video where you upload a massive, 500-page spec book, and the user watches the AI instantly extract and build a clean, formatted submittal log. This visual is pure magic to anyone who currently does this manually.
- **Direct LinkedIn Outreach:** Search for "Project Engineer", "Project Manager", or "Estimator" at electrical, mechanical, and GC firms. Send a direct message:

"Hey [Name], I used to spend hours manually highlighting spec books and building submittal logs, so I built an AI tool that does it in 3 minutes. I'm looking for 5 PMs to test it out for free. Interested in seeing a 60-second demo?"

- **Content Marketing:** Post tips about project management, submittal pitfalls, and your journey building the app on LinkedIn.
 - **Niche Communities:** Engage (don't spam) in Reddit communities like r/construction, r/estimators, or r/MEPEngineering.
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4. What Else to Think About (Post-Dev Checklist)

Now that the heavy lifting is done, the focus shifts to user experience and trust:

- **The Onboarding Experience (Crucial):** The first 5 minutes dictate whether a user stays or churns. When they sign up, give them a **"1-Click Sample Project"** pre-loaded with specs and a tracker so they can immediately play with the UI without having to upload their own documents first.
 - **Feedback Loops:** Add a simple "Give Feedback" or "Report a Bug" button directly in the app sidebar. Make it frictionless for them to tell you what's broken.
 - **Data Security & Privacy:** Construction firms are paranoid about NDAs and proprietary project data. Have a clear, simple Privacy Policy that explicitly states: *"We do not train public AI models on your proprietary blueprints or specifications. Your data is yours."*
 - **Analytics:** Set up basic product analytics (like PostHog or Google Analytics) to see where users drop off. Are they getting stuck on the PDF upload? Are they exporting to Excel but never coming back? Data will tell you what to fix next.
 - **Professional Infrastructure:** Ensure hello@submittaltrackerpro.com is set up and your domain is properly verified so your emails don't go to spam.
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5. Training & Onboarding Strategy

Please **do not** write a 20-page PDF manual! In the software world: *"If you have to read a manual to use the software, the design has failed."*

Here is exactly how you should handle training:

- **The "White-Glove" Beta Onboarding:** For your first 5 to 10 testers, do not let them figure it out alone. Jump on a 15-minute Zoom/Teams call. Get their account set up and watch them build their first project via screen share. You will learn more about where your UI is confusing in 15 minutes of watching them click around than in 5 months of guessing.
- **The 2-Minute Loom Video:** Instead of a PDF manual, record a 2 to 3-minute screen recording

using Loom. Show yourself creating a project, uploading a PDF, and clicking extract. Include this link in their welcome email. It is highly visual and engaging.

- **Let the Interface Do the Teaching:** Rely on empty states (like the ones we built on the dashboard) to guide users. If they log in and have no projects, the dashboard should clearly instruct them: *"No workspaces found. Click 'New Project' to get started."*
- **Future Upgrade (Demo Project):** Eventually, when a user signs up, automatically populate their account with a "Demo Project" that has a few submittals already extracted. Let them click around a finished product to see the value immediately before asking them to do any work.

Next Step Recommendation:

If you haven't already, I would highly recommend recording a quick, polished Loom video of the platform working perfectly. It will be the single most important asset you have for getting those first 5 beta testers!